

# Study Questions: Learning — From Following Patterns to Writing Them

1. Describe the three stages of pattern literacy (following, modifying, designing) in terms of generative model complexity. What capability does each stage add?
2. How does a failed project update your generative model differently than a successful one? Give a specific crochet example.
3. Why are prediction errors (mistakes) the most powerful drivers of learning? What do they signal about your model?
4. Explain how writing a crochet pattern from scratch is the ultimate test of your generative model. What capabilities must the model possess?
5. How does watching another crocheter work in a crochet circle accelerate your own model growth?
6. A beginner finishes their first scarf. What specific model updates has this project provided?
7. Compare the learning that happens from making the same pattern 5 times versus making 5 different patterns once each. Which builds a broader model?
8. How does teaching someone to crochet reveal the implicit knowledge in your own generative model?
9. When you try a new technique (like Tunisian crochet) for the first time, how does your existing crochet model partially transfer? Where does it fail?
10. Explain why the emotional pain of frogging a large section serves a learning function. How does the emotional signal strengthen the model update?
11. A crocheter who has only ever made rectangles (scarves, blankets) attempts their first hat. What new model capabilities must they develop?

12. How does a crochet-along (CAL) structure the learning process differently than working independently?
13. Describe the process of reverse-engineering a finished object (looking at a hat and figuring out how it was made) as a form of learning. What model capabilities does it build?
14. How does maintaining a project journal (recording gauge, modifications, outcomes) accelerate model growth compared to relying on memory alone?
15. Why might a crocheter who designs their own patterns continue to learn from other designers' patterns?
16. Explain the role of deliberate practice in crochet learning. How is practicing a new stitch on a swatch different from practicing within a real project?
17. A crocheter says "I learn more from my mistakes than my successes." Validate this claim using Active Inference concepts.
18. How does the availability of YouTube tutorials change the learning process compared to learning from written patterns alone?
19. When a pattern designer receives feedback that their pattern had an error, how does this update the designer's generative model?
20. Describe your own learning trajectory in crochet. Where are you on the follower-modifier-designer spectrum, and what would it take to move to the next level?